



UNIVERSITY OF
LIVERPOOL

Faculty of Science and Engineering
School of Computer Science and Informatics

University of Liverpool PhD Thesis LaTeX Template Guide

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by

Template Documentation

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Abstract

This document is both the user guide and the working example for the University of Liverpool PhD thesis LaTeX template. It demonstrates the required title-page information, preliminary pages, Roman and Arabic page numbering, chapter structure, figures, tables, mathematics, algorithms, source code, references and appendices. Candidates should replace the explanatory material with their own thesis and confirm discipline-specific conventions with their supervisor.

Declaration

The declaration in a submitted thesis must accurately describe the candidate's original contribution and any material completed jointly with others. Replace this instructional paragraph with the declaration agreed for the thesis; do not retain template text in the submitted document.

Acknowledgements

Use this optional section to acknowledge supervision, funding, facilities, collaboration and personal support. Keep acknowledgements professional and check whether a funder requires a particular grant statement.

List of Publications

1. L. Lamport, *LaTeX: A Document Preparation System*, 2nd ed. Reading, Massachusetts: Addison-Wesley, 1994
2. University of Liverpool, “Our history,” <https://www.liverpool.ac.uk/about/the-university/our-history/>, accessed 31 July 2026

Contents

Abstract	ii
Declaration	iii
Acknowledgements	iv
List of Publications	v
List of Figures	viii
List of Tables	ix
List of Abbreviations and Symbols	x
1 About This Template	1
1.1 Purpose and scope	1
1.2 The University of Liverpool	1
1.3 Files supplied with the template	2
2 Preparing the Thesis	3
2.1 Document declaration and metadata	3
2.2 Front matter	3
2.3 Main matter and chapter files	4
3 Text, Mathematics and Lists	5
3.1 Headings and paragraphs	5
3.2 Lists	5
3.3 Equations and cross-references	5
4 Figures and Tables	6
4.1 Figures	6
4.2 Tables	6
4.3 Float placement	6
5 Algorithms and Source Code	7
5.1 Algorithms	7
5.2 Source code	7
6 Citations, References and Appendices	8
6.1 Choosing a reference style	8
6.2 Printing the reference list	9
6.3 Appendices after references	9
6.4 Theses incorporating publications	9

7 Pre-submission Checklist	10
References	11
A Minimal Thesis Skeleton	12
A.1 Common customisations	13

List of Figures

1.1 The University of Liverpool campus and the Victoria Building. 1

List of Tables

1.1	Principal files and their roles.	2
4.1	Example comparison using ordinary table syntax.	6
6.1	Accepted discipline= values and their default bibliography styles.	8

List of Abbreviations and Symbols

AI Artificial intelligence

PGR Postgraduate researcher

UoL University of Liverpool

α Example mathematical symbol

1. About This Template

1.1 Purpose and scope

This guide follows the organisation of established scholarly author guides: it starts with a minimal document structure, explains each supported component, and finishes with submission checks and reusable source examples. The class encodes a consistent A4 thesis layout, but it does not replace the University’s current PGR guidance or advice from a School or supervisor [3].

The source of this guide is intentionally written as ordinary LaTeX. Authors can copy a demonstrated construct directly, replace its content, and remove the surrounding explanatory prose. Commands intended to be edited are kept in `example.tex`; layout decisions belong in `liverpoolthesis.cls` and `liverpoolthesis.sty`.

1.2 The University of Liverpool

The University began as University College, Liverpool in 1881 and was established as the University of Liverpool by Royal Charter in 1903. Its Victoria Building, opened in 1892, helped establish Liverpool’s identity as the original “redbrick” university. Today the University describes itself as a founding member of the Russell Group with a research tradition that connects the institution to the city and to international partners [2, 4].



Figure 1.1: The University of Liverpool campus and the Victoria Building.

Figure 1.1 also demonstrates the preferred structure of an ordinary figure: centre the graphic, place the caption below it, and add the label after the caption. Use descriptive captions that allow a reader to understand the figure without searching through the main text.

1.3 Files supplied with the template

Table 1.1: Principal files and their roles.

File	Purpose
<code>example.tex</code>	Thesis content, metadata and package configuration.
<code>liverpoolthesis.cls</code>	Page geometry, title page, front matter, numbering, fonts and PDF metadata.
<code>liverpoolthesis.sty</code>	Headings, captions, tables, lists, theorems, algorithms, source code and discipline-aware references.
<code>liverpoolthesis.bst</code>	Bundled IEEE-compatible BibTeX style used automatically for engineering, computing and technology disciplines.
<code>references.bib</code>	Bibliographic records processed by BibTeX.
<code>uol-figures/</code>	Template-owned logo and demonstration campus image.
<code>README.md</code>	Concise setup, bibliography and compilation instructions.

Keep the class, style, bibliography style and `uol-figures` directory together when moving the project. The logo is selected internally by the class and should not be specified again in the thesis source.

2. Preparing the Thesis

2.1 Document declaration and metadata

The opening block supplies the title-page text and searchable PDF information. Faculty and School names are deliberately configurable and may be left empty if they are not required.

```
1 \documentclass[oneside,header=right]{liverpoolthesis}
2 \usepackage[discipline=computer-science]{liverpoolthesis}
3
4 \title{Title of the Thesis}
5 \author{Full Forenames and Surname}
6 \faculty{Faculty Name}
7 \school{School, Institute or Department Name}
8 \degree{Doctor in Philosophy}
9 \date{Month Year}
10 \subject{Short description of the research}
11 \keywords{keyword one, keyword two, keyword three}
12
13 % Default: numbered chapters, sections and subsections.
14 \setcounter{secnumdepth}{2} % Use -1 to suppress all heading numbers.
```

For double-sided printing, replace the `oneside` and `header=right` options with `twoside` and `header=outer`; the latter places running heads at the outer edge of each printed page. The alternatives `header=left`, `header=right`, `header=inner` and `header=outer` select a fixed left position, a fixed right position, odd-left/even-right positions and odd-right/even-left positions respectively. The default `header=auto` chooses right for `oneside` and `outer` for `twoside`. The same selection can be made in the preamble with, for example, `\thesisheaderstyle{inner}`. Chapter-opening pages retain the conventional header-free plain style.

2.2 Front matter

Place `\frontmatter` before `\maketitle`. The title page is counted as Roman page *i* but does not print the number; subsequent preliminary pages use lower-case Roman numerals. Annexe 1 requires a title page, an abstract, and a table of contents containing chapter headings, page numbers and every separate section of the thesis. The demonstration additionally includes the following useful preliminary sections where applicable:

1. Abstract;
2. Declaration;
3. Acknowledgements;
4. List of Publications;
5. Table of Contents;
6. List of Figures;

7. List of Tables; and
8. List of Abbreviations and Symbols.

The abstract environment is single-spaced automatically. Annexe 1 limits it to one side of A4, normally about 450 words, and requires it to state the aims and results of the investigation [3]. The other preliminary sections inherit the normal thesis spacing.

List publications from references.bib rather than retyping their details. Replace the demonstration keys with the keys for the candidate's own outputs:

```

1 \begin{publications}
2   \item \publication{your-first-paper}
3   \item \publication{your-second-paper}
4 \end{publications}
```

Listing 2.1: Generating the List of Publications from BibTeX data.

2.3 Main matter and chapter files

Place \mainmatter immediately before the first chapter. Arabic page numbering then restarts at 1. A long thesis is easier to maintain when chapters are stored in separate files:

```

1 \mainmatter
2 \include{chapters/introduction}
3 \include{chapters/literature-review}
4 \include{chapters/methodology}
5 \include{chapters/results}
6 \include{chapters/conclusions}
```

Listing 2.2: Including separate chapter files.

Each included file should normally begin with \chapter{...} and should not contain another \documentclass or \begin{document} command.

3. Text, Mathematics and Lists

3.1 Headings and paragraphs

Use numbered `\chapter`, `\section` and `\subsection` commands to express the logical hierarchy. Avoid manual font-size and colour commands in headings: the style file applies the Liverpool blue hierarchy consistently and creates navigable PDF bookmarks.

The preamble setting `\setcounter{secnumdepth}{2}` prints numbers on chapters, sections and subsections. Thus `\chapter{Introduction}` begins with “1. Introduction”. Use 1 to stop numbering after sections, 0 to number chapters only, or -1 to suppress all heading numbers.

Start a new paragraph with a blank source line. Do not use repeated line breaks or manual vertical space to imitate paragraph spacing. The class also applies widow and orphan control, restrained emergency line breaking, and consistent spacing around displayed material.

3.2 Lists

Use the standard list environments. For example:

- use `itemize` when order is not significant;
- use `enumerate` for a sequence or procedure; and
- keep items grammatically parallel and reasonably concise.

The template supplies moderate vertical separation suitable for a thesis rather than the compressed spacing common in short conference papers.

3.3 Equations and cross-references

Displayed equations should be punctuated as part of the surrounding sentence. For example, the arithmetic mean of observations $x_1, \dots, x_n$ is

$$\bar{x} = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n x_i, \tag{3.1}$$

where n is the number of observations. Refer to it with `Equation~\ref{eq:mean}`, which produces Equation 3.1.

Theorem 3.1 (Arithmetic–geometric mean). *For non-negative values $x_1, \dots, x_n$, the arithmetic mean is no smaller than the geometric mean.*

Proof. This familiar result is included only to demonstrate the theorem and proof styles supplied by the template. □

Numbered theorem-style variants are available for lemmas, propositions, corollaries and conjectures. Definition-style variants cover definitions, assumptions and examples, while remarks use a lighter style. All can be referenced in the same way, for example Theorem 3.1.

4. Figures and Tables

4.1 Figures

Use common PDF, PNG or JPEG graphics and size them relative to `\textwidth` or `\linewidth`. Preserve the image aspect ratio and ensure labels remain legible at the final printed size. Every figure must be mentioned in the text, numbered, captioned and supplied with alternative explanation in the surrounding prose where accessibility requires it.

```
1 \begin{figure}[htbp]
2   \centering
3   \includegraphics[width=0.85\textwidth]{figures/result.pdf}
4   \caption{A self-contained description of the result.}
5   \label{fig:result}
6 \end{figure}
```

Listing 4.1: Standard figure syntax.

4.2 Tables

Use ordinary table and tabular environments. Captions appear above tables automatically. The booktabs rules produce a clear journal-style table without vertical lines, as demonstrated in Table 4.1.

Table 4.1: Example comparison using ordinary table syntax.

Method	Accuracy (%)	Time (s)	Comment
Baseline method	84.2	12.6	Reference result
Proposed method	91.7	8.4	Best overall

For wide textual content, use fixed-width `p{width}` columns or the available `tabularx` environment. The optional `S` column from `siunitx` aligns decimal numbers, but it is unnecessary for simple tables.

4.3 Float placement

The placement option `[htbp]` asks LaTeX to try the current position, the top or bottom of a page, and finally a dedicated float page. Avoid forcing every float with `[H]`; allowing controlled movement usually produces better page balance. The style file permits several floats while preventing almost empty text pages and sparsely occupied float pages.

5. Algorithms and Source Code

5.1 Algorithms

Use the `algorithm` float with `algpseudocode` for procedures. Algorithms are numbered by chapter and can be referenced with ordinary `\ref` commands.

Algorithm 5.1 Example iterative procedure

Require: Initial value x_0 and tolerance ε

```
1:  $k \leftarrow 0$ 
2: while the stopping criterion is not satisfied do
3:   compute the next value  $x_{k+1}$ 
4:    $k \leftarrow k + 1$ 
5: end while
6: return  $x_k$ 
```

5.2 Source code

The `listings` configuration provides line numbers, restrained colour, automatic wrapping and an embedded monospaced font. Short fragments should support the research narrative; move extensive implementation details to an appendix or a maintained repository.

```
1 def mean(values):
2     """Return the arithmetic mean."""
3     if not values:
4         raise ValueError("values must not be empty")
5     return sum(values) / len(values)
```

Listing 5.1: Example source-code presentation.

Algorithm 5.1 and Listing 5.1 demonstrate conventional cross-references using `\ref`.

6. Citations, References and Appendices

6.1 Choosing a reference style

The University requires references to be complete, consistent and presented in a form accepted within the relevant discipline; it does not impose one University-wide citation style [3]. Select the discipline once and the template selects a suitable BibTeX .bst style:

```
1 \usepackage[discipline=computer-science]{liverpoolthesis}
```

The value after discipline= must be copied from the middle column of Table 6.1. Values are lower-case and use hyphens instead of spaces; for example, Computer Science is written exactly as computer-science, not computerscience.

Table 6.1: Accepted discipline= values and their default bibliography styles.

Discipline group	Accepted parameter values	Selected style
Engineering, computing and technology	engineering, electrical-engineering, electronic-engineering, mechanical-engineering, civil-engineering, aerospace-engineering, chemical-engineering, materials-engineering, biomedical-engineering, systems-engineering, energy-engineering, computer-science, computing, data-science, artificial-intelligence, robotics, telecommunications	IEEE numeric
Medicine, health and natural sciences	physics, astronomy, chemistry, mathematics, statistics, medicine, dentistry, veterinary-science, nursing, pharmacy, public-health, health-sciences, life-sciences, biology, biochemistry, genetics, neuroscience, environmental-science, earth-sciences, geology, ocean-sciences, agriculture, food-science	compact numeric
Psychology, education, management and social sciences	general, psychology, education, social-sciences, sociology, anthropology, criminology, politics, international-relations, public-policy, social-work, management, business, marketing, geography, sport-science	APA
Economics, humanities and arts	economics, finance, accounting, humanities, history, archaeology, classics, philosophy, literature, languages, linguistics, music, arts, architecture, planning, communication, media-studies, theology	author-year
Law	law	author-title

APA remains the fallback for `discipline=general` or an unrecognised value. A School-mandated style can override the mapping explicitly:

```
1 \usepackage[
2   discipline=computer-science,
3   style=apa
4 ]{liverpoolthesis}
```

The selector maps the discipline to the bundled `liverpoolthesis.bst` or to a standard BibTeX style supplied by the TeX installation. The selected style is written to the auxiliary file automatically, while the references themselves remain in an ordinary `.bib` database.

Store bibliographic data in `references.bib`. Use `\cite{key}` for a parenthetical citation and `\citet{key}` for a textual citation; the resulting entries are formatted consistently rather than typed manually [1].

6.2 Printing the reference list

The following command creates an unnumbered References chapter. The template automatically starts it on a fresh page, creates the PDF hyperlink target and adds it to the table of contents:

```
1 \bibliography{references}
```

6.3 Appendices after references

Appendices may follow the reference list. Use `\appendix` directly and continue with ordinary chapter commands. Do not place `\backmatter` before the appendices, because doing so suppresses the Appendix A, Appendix B chapter numbering provided by the base class.

6.4 Theses incorporating publications

A List of Publications does not by itself make the document a thesis that incorporates publications. Candidates using published work in place of standard chapters should agree the approach with their supervisors and follow Annexe 2 [5]. In particular:

1. the thesis must contain a conventional Introduction explaining the background and rationale;
2. additional literature or methods chapters should supply depth and coherence not provided by the publications;
3. every incorporated publication must be presented as a chapter with an introductory section linking it to the preceding and following work;
4. a Conclusion must integrate the strands of all chapters and papers;
5. each publication requires a declaration of the candidate's contribution, and jointly authored work requires the necessary co-author permissions;
6. published material must be reformatted into the thesis style with continuous pagination, rather than inserted in the publisher's layout.

7. Pre-submission Checklist

Before producing the examination copy, check the following items:

1. Replace every placeholder in the title page and preliminary pages.
2. Confirm the current University and School requirements.
3. Check that the abstract fits the permitted length and page limit.
4. Check the applicable maximum word count: Appendix 7 states that it includes footnotes and appendices but excludes the bibliography.
5. Ensure every figure and table is cited, legible and correctly captioned.
6. Resolve all missing citations, references and compilation warnings.
7. Use one accepted reference style consistently throughout the thesis.
8. Confirm that permissions and source acknowledgements are complete.
9. Submit supporting material in the same PDF where practicable and consult the relevant Director of PGR about material that cannot be embedded.
10. Inspect the final PDF page by page, including bookmarks, pagination, equations, appendices and embedded fonts.

Automated formatting improves consistency but does not validate scholarly content. The candidate remains responsible for accuracy, attribution, accessibility and compliance with the requirements applying at submission.

References

- [1] L. Lamport, *LaTeX: A Document Preparation System*, 2nd ed. Reading, Massachusetts: Addison-Wesley, 1994.
- [2] University of Liverpool, “Our history,” <https://www.liverpool.ac.uk/about/the-university/our-history/>, accessed 31 July 2026.
- [3] —, “Guidelines for formatting and presentation of a PGR degree thesis to UoL for examination,” <https://www.liverpool.ac.uk/media/livacuk/tqsd/code-of-practice-on-assessment/annex-7.1-PGR-CoP.pdf>, 2025, accessed 31 July 2026.
- [4] —, “Research,” <https://www.liverpool.ac.uk/research/>, accessed 31 July 2026.
- [5] —, “Guidelines on presentation of publications within a PGR thesis,” <https://www.liverpool.ac.uk/media/livacuk/tqsd/code-of-practice-on-assessment/annex-7.2-PGR-CoP.pdf>, 2025, accessed 31 July 2026.

A. Minimal Thesis Skeleton

The following skeleton shows the intended order without the explanatory content used elsewhere in this guide.

```
1 \documentclass[oneside,header=right]{liverpoolthesis}
2 \usepackage[discipline=computer-science]{liverpoolthesis}
3
4 \begin{document}
5 \frontmatter
6 \maketitle
7
8 \begin{abstract}
9 Abstract text.
10 \end{abstract}
11
12 \begin{declaration}
13 Declaration text.
14 \end{declaration}
15
16 \begin{acknowledgements}
17 Acknowledgements text.
18 \end{acknowledgements}
19
20 \begin{publications}
21   \item \publication{your-publication-key}
22 \end{publications}
23
24 \tableofcontents
25 \listoffigures
26 \listoftables
27
28 \begin{abbreviations}
29   \item[UoL] University of Liverpool
30 \end{abbreviations}
31
32 \mainmatter
33 \chapter{Introduction}
34 Thesis text.
35
36 \bibliography{references}
37
38 \appendix
39 \chapter{Supplementary Material}
40 Appendix text.
41 \end{document}
```

Listing A.1: Minimal document skeleton.

A.1 Common customisations

Prefer semantic changes in `example.tex` and reserve visual changes for the class or companion style. This separation keeps the thesis source readable and makes global revisions predictable. If a School requires a different bibliography style, margin, heading treatment or declaration, document the reason for the change and apply it consistently rather than formatting individual pages by hand.